

MSC Trust

Inventory Management System

Bulk Import Feature - Comprehensive User Manual

Generated for Admin & Staff Roles

Version 2.0

1. Introduction to Bulk Import

The Bulk Import feature allows you to upload hundreds or thousands of inventory items and groceries into the MSC Trust system in a single click using a CSV (Comma Separated Values) spreadsheet file.

Pro Tip: You don't have to guess the format! The system provides a "**Download Template**" button directly in the modal. Always use this template to ensure your columns are perfectly aligned.

2. Admin vs. Staff Access

The Bulk Import tool smartly adapts based on who is logged in:

For Admins

- **Global Visibility:** Admins can upload stock to *any* branch.
- **Branch Selection:** When the bulk import window opens, Admins will see a "Target Branch" dropdown. You must select which branch the spreadsheet belongs to before clicking upload.

For Staff

- **Restricted Scope:** Staff members are permanently bound to their assigned branch.
- **Automatic Routing:** Staff will *not* see a branch dropdown. Any CSV file they upload is automatically routed and assigned to their branch. They cannot accidentally overwrite or add stock to another facility.

3. The Groceries Integration

We have introduced a dedicated **Groceries** section to track food and provisions separately from standard supplies. However, the bulk import process is seamlessly unified.

How to import Groceries: In your CSV file, simply type **Groceries** in the **Category** column. The system will automatically intercept these items and display them on the new dedicated Groceries page, while continuing to manage them under standard stock rules.

4. Spreadsheet Format (Column by Column)

When filling out your CSV file, each row represents one item. Here is a detailed breakdown of every required and optional column.

Column Name	Required?	Description & Rules
Item Name	Yes	The primary name of the item (e.g., "Paracetamol", "Rice 5kg"). Must not be empty.
Category	Optional	Groups the items. Type Groceries here to send the item to the Groceries page. Otherwise, use categories like "Medical", "Stationery", etc.
Stock	Yes	The current numerical quantity (e.g., 50 , 100). Must be a valid number.
Unit	Optional	How the item is measured (e.g., Kg , Boxes , Strips , Pieces).
Threshold	Optional	The low-stock warning limit. If Stock drops below this number, the dashboard alerts you. Defaults to 10 if left blank.
Unit Price	Optional	The monetary value of a single unit. E.g., 15.50 . Do not include currency symbols.
Supplier	Optional	The name of the vendor. Important: The spelling must <i>exactly match</i> an existing supplier in the system, otherwise it will be left blank.
Program	Optional	The trust program this item belongs to. Spelling must exactly match an existing program.
Item Code	Optional	A custom internal code for barcode scanning or tracking (e.g., MED-001).
Serial Number	Optional	Unique identifier for electronics or high-value items.

Column Name	Required?	Description & Rules
Block	Optional	The physical storage block inside the branch. Spelling must perfectly match the existing blocks created by the admin for that branch.

5. Error Handling and "Other Stuffs"

What happens when something goes wrong during a massive import? The system is designed to protect your data.

Atomic Uploads (All or Nothing)

If you upload a spreadsheet with 500 rows, and row #499 has a missing "Item Name" (a required field), the system will **reject the entire file**. It will not import 498 items and leave you guessing what failed. It protects database integrity.

Duplicate Item Names

If an Item Name in your CSV already exists in that specific branch:

- The system will **skip creating a new item**.
- Instead, it will safely **add the new stock quantity** to the existing item.
- This makes the bulk import tool excellent for conducting monthly stock-takes or receiving massive multi-item shipments without creating duplicate entries.

Handling Errors

If a CSV fails, the screen will display a red alert box. Read the message carefully. It will usually say something like: `"Row 15: Missing Item Name"` or `"Stock must be a valid number"`. Fix the error in Excel, save as CSV, and try again.

Final Checklist before uploading:

- Is the file saved strictly as `.csv` (not `.xlsx`)?
- Did you avoid putting commas inside numerical fields (e.g., use `1000` not `1,000`)?
- Are your Supplier and Block names spelled exactly as they are in the database?